

A century of sacred light, heralding a

NEW ERA OF AWAKENING

The centenary celebration held at Shantikunj linked a hundred years of devotion, discipline and dedication with a renewed resolve for the future. In the presence of saints, public leaders and thousands of spiritual seekers, the flame of the 'akhand deep' conveyed a message of renewed awakening for humanity, culture and global consciousness.

In the flow of every era, there are certain moments that do not merely pass with the currents of time. Instead, they leave an enduring imprint on human consciousness for generations to come. When penance, faith and resolve unite to inspire collective energy among people, history records not just events but the beginning of a new age. The centenary celebration held at Shantikunj and Bairagi Dweep in Haridwar emerged as one such spiritual endeavour. Through the ideals of sadhana (spiritual discipline), seva (service) and sanskar (values), the event created a deeply devotional and uplifting atmosphere. The occasion marked three significant milestones: the birth centenary of the revered founder of the Akhil Vishwa Gayatri Parivar, Param Vandaniya Mata Bhagwati Devi Sharma, the centenary of the Akhand Deep (eternal lamp) that has remained continuously lit since 1926, and one hundred years of the intense spiritual penance of Yugrishi Pandit Shriram Sharma Acharya. The lamp that has burned continuously for a century is not merely a flame—it is a symbol of a sacred resolve. It represents the spiritual vision of a seer who dreamt of a brighter future for humanity and devoted his life to transforming that vision into reality.

A testament to tireless toil and total dedication

The centenary celebrations did not begin with a formal ceremony but with a collective pledge of service and voluntary effort. Preparations commenced on 12 November 2025 at Bairagi Dweep with a cleanliness drive and shramdaan (voluntary labour). Thousands of volunteers contributed their time and energy to transform the venue into what came to be known as "Shatabdi Nagar." During these preparations, the active involvement of the Gayatri Parivar's young leadership was particularly visible. Dr. Chinmay Pandya, Pro-Vice Chancellor of Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya and a youth icon of the Gayatri Parivar, continuously supervised the

